

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Cyber Security Analyst | Microsoft Sentinel | Threat Detection and Response | Incident Management | Vulnerability Assessment

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)-certified Senior Cyber Security Analyst with over five years of experience leading threat detection, incident management, vulnerability assessment, and security operations functions in complex enterprise environments. I have deep hands-on experience with Microsoft Sentinel and Kusto Query Language (KQL), Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) platforms, Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) tooling, Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR) via CrowdStrike Falcon, and identity security through Microsoft Entra ID. I have protected environments of 8,000-plus users, led Managed Security Service Provider (MSSP) engagements for cyber security incident management, developed and maintained incident response playbooks, and conducted structured threat hunting campaigns using the MITRE ATT&CK framework. I excel in hybrid, collaborative environments where I partner with technical teams and communicate clearly with senior stakeholders to reduce risk and strengthen security posture.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **SIEM:** Microsoft Sentinel (KQL, analytic rules, workbooks, watchlists), CrowdStrike NG-SIEM, Splunk/SPL
- **SOAR:** CrowdStrike Fusion SOAR, Microsoft Sentinel automation; playbook development, alert enrichment, automated containment
- **Threat Detection and Response:** Detection engineering, alert triage (L2/L3), threat hunting (MITRE ATT&CK), incident investigation and containment, security playbook development
- **Incident Management:** NIST 800-61 incident response lifecycle; coordination with Managed Security Service Providers (MSSPs); root-cause analysis and post-incident reporting
- **EDR/XDR:** CrowdStrike Falcon (Prevent, Insight, Discover, NG-SIEM); Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft 365 Defender
- **Vulnerability Assessment and Remediation:** Tenable.io, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), AppCheck, Nessus; risk-based prioritisation and remediation tracking
- **Identity and Access Security:** Microsoft Entra ID / Azure Active Directory (AD), Conditional Access, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), Single Sign-On (SSO), BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM)
- **Email Security:** Mimecast; anti-phishing, URL protection, inbound threat management
- **Scripting and Automation:** PowerShell; SOAR automation; detection rule authoring and tuning
- **Frameworks:** NIST CSF, MITRE ATT&CK, CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts, London (UAL) - Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer *March 2025 - Present*

- Lead threat detection and incident management for an 8,000-plus user estate; triage, investigate, and contain security incidents from detection through to resolution using NIST 800-61 methodology
- Administer Microsoft Sentinel as the primary Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) platform; develop and maintain KQL-based analytic rules, alert correlation, workbooks, and watchlists to surface high-priority threats across cloud and on-premises environments
- Manage the CrowdStrike Falcon platform across Prevent, Insight, Discover, NG-SIEM, and Fusion SOAR modules; tune detections, reduce false positives, and maintain platform health for an 8,000-plus user deployment
- Develop SOAR automation playbooks in CrowdStrike Fusion SOAR and Microsoft Sentinel to automate alert enrichment, triage, and containment actions; reducing analyst workload on repetitive events
- Coordinate with Managed Security Service Provider (MSSP) partners for cyber security incident management; define escalation paths, review MSSP-generated alerts, and lead investigations requiring deeper analysis

- Conduct proactive threat hunting using the MITRE ATT&CK framework; develop structured hunting hypotheses, execute hunts across Sentinel and CrowdStrike telemetry, and translate findings into new detection rules
- Lead vulnerability assessment activities using Tenable.io and Pentera BAS; execute scan cycles, triage findings by severity, develop remediation plans, and track closure with asset owners and infrastructure teams
- Maintain and improve security playbooks for incident response, phishing response, and identity-based attacks; ensure playbooks are tested, reviewed, and aligned to current threat landscape
- Produce security metrics, threat intelligence summaries, and executive-level risk reports; communicate security posture and emerging risks to IT Security leadership and governance bodies
- Manage Microsoft Entra ID Conditional Access policies, MFA enforcement, and BeyondTrust PAM access reviews; enforce least-privilege and reduce identity attack surface

University of the Arts, London (UAL) - Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity

March 2022 - March 2025

- Deployed and operationalised Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) across an 8,000-user estate; improved endpoint and identity threat detection coverage and consolidated alerting within Microsoft 365 Defender
- Built and maintained detection rules, analytic rules, and KQL queries in Microsoft Sentinel; monitored alerts daily, performed incident triage, and escalated confirmed threats within the SOC workflow
- Performed vulnerability assessments using Nessus and AppCheck; triaged scan outputs, coordinated remediation with infrastructure teams, and maintained patch compliance tracking
- Managed MSSP relationships for incident management activities; reviewed and validated MSSP-generated alerts and participated in joint incident response exercises
- Maintained and authored incident response playbooks aligned to NIST 800-61; delivered training to junior analysts on triage procedures and escalation paths
- Administered Mimecast email security; reviewed inbound threat intelligence, investigated phishing campaigns, and enforced email security policies
- Configured Microsoft Entra ID / Azure AD Conditional Access, MFA, and SSO policies; supported identity governance reviews and access entitlement management
- Contributed to Cyber Essentials Plus accreditation; gathered evidence, addressed control gaps, and liaised with the certifying body across two successful certification cycles
- Monitored security tooling health and conducted trend analysis on security events; provided weekly security reporting to IT management

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech) - IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

February 2021 - March 2022

- Implemented and managed security controls across cloud and on-premises infrastructure in a fast-paced SaaS/FinTech environment, with responsibility spanning endpoint security, identity management, and infrastructure security
- Configured identity and access management controls including MFA and SSO; enforced security policies and conducted access reviews to minimise privilege creep
- Performed vulnerability scanning and assisted with remediation tracking; maintained patch management schedules and reported on control effectiveness
- Managed Microsoft Intune Mobile Device Management (MDM) and Mobile Application Management (MAM) policies; enforced device compliance and controlled application access across the organisation
- Supported ISO 27001 compliance activities; conducted risk assessments, maintained security documentation, and assisted with internal audit preparation
- Monitored network infrastructure and responded to security incidents; contributed to root-cause analysis and implemented lessons learned following events

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Designed and implemented a comprehensive SIEM detection engineering programme in Microsoft Sentinel, authoring over 40 custom KQL analytic rules covering identity threats, lateral movement, and data exfiltration scenarios aligned to MITRE ATT&CK

- Led structured threat hunting campaigns using CrowdStrike Falcon Insight and Microsoft Sentinel telemetry, identifying previously undetected adversary behaviour and converting findings into new detection content
- Developed and automated SOAR playbooks in CrowdStrike Fusion SOAR that reduced manual analyst effort on repetitive triage tasks by enabling automated enrichment and response actions
- Delivered an 8,000-user Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Defender for Identity (MDI) rollout, consolidating endpoint and identity threat detection into a unified Microsoft 365 Defender environment
- Established a vulnerability management programme using Tenable.io and Pentera BAS with a structured scan cadence, risk-based remediation prioritisation, and executive-level reporting
- Maintained Cyber Essentials Plus certification across two consecutive cycles; coordinated evidence gathering and remediated control gaps identified during the assessment process

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
 - CompTIA Security+
 - Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
 - CompTIA A+
 - Google IT Support Professional Certificate
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References available on request | Hybrid (Birmingham/UK)